

Declarer Sheet — Suit

Bridge Habit Map

AUCTION

General

- ☐ Check vulnerability
- ☐ Use every bid to get info — partner + opps → HCP + shape
- ☐ Start from minimum length & min HCP promised — refine as bids land
- ☐ Bids not made are as important as bids made (e.g. passed → not 1 opener, no 6-card major)
- ☐ Remember conventions tend to show the bidder's shape / HCP
- ☐ By end of auction — summarise what you know about opps + partner

Lead prep (if you'll be on lead)

- ☐ Pick a tentative opening lead during the auction, not after
- ☐ Watch for lead-directing double opportunities on artificial bids

PLAN — DISCIPLINE & LEAD

Discipline

- ☐ Pause at least 10 seconds before playing from dummy
- ☐ Treat it as a play problem handed to you on paper
- ☐ Review the auction — what's bid, what's not

- ☐ Analyse the opening lead — length, honor, shortness?

PLAN — SUIT

Count

- ☐ Count losers in each suit
- ☐ Pick a master hand (long-trump hand; stronger in 4-4)
- ☐ Cross-check by counting winners

Source of extras

- ☐ Can dummy cover losers? (ruffs, side-suit, finesse, throw-in)
- ☐ Consider dummy reversal, cross-ruff, loser-on-loser, endplay

Trump management

- ☐ Draw trumps now or postpone?
- ☐ If ruffs needed in dummy — set up before drawing
- ☐ Estimate trump leads needed; count opps' trumps as you go

Hazards & control

- ☐ What will defenders attack when they get in?
- ☐ Identify the danger hand — keep them off lead

Execution

- ☐ Plan entries between hands
- ☐ Decide order of attack across suits